



Civic Meeting Report

City Council Meeting March 3rd 2025

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=C_0FRD6oFLQ
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Monthly Common Council Meeting Report

Meeting Date: March 3rd

Body: Muncie Common Council

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

No statutory public hearings or committee work sessions were held prior to calling the regular meeting to order.

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding Officer called the March 3rd meeting of the Monthly Common Council to order at [00:00:23](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Macintosh, Basham, Green, Dishman, Garrett, Selby, Goan, Howell, and President Mason (Total: 9 present).
 - **Members Absent:** None.
 - **Presiding Officer:** President Mason.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:**
 - Pledge of Allegiance led by the Council 00:00:29.
 - Invocation delivered by Councilman Green 00:00:54.
 - Citizen Recognition: Sarah Gillian Goan presented a community recognition honoring long-term educator Drew Shettler (Central High School teacher) for his dedication and community impact 00:01:36.
- **Approval of Minutes:** The minutes from the February meeting were approved as presented, following a motion by council person Selby and a second by councilman Brandon Garrett 00:00:56.
- **Board & Commission Appointments:**
 - Nomination of Linda M. McWay to the Muncie Human Rights Commission, made by council person Gilliam and seconded by council person Howell 00:01:42.
 - Appointee Linda McWay spoke briefly regarding her prior service and appreciation for the reappointment 00:01:45.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by unanimous roll call vote (9-0) 00:01:26.

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- 00:12:54 **Ordinance 29-24:** Previously introduced ordinance.
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Presiding Officer / Sponsor.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The sponsor requested to withdraw the ordinance at this time.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Withdrawn.
- 00:13:27 **Ordinance 30-24:** An Ordinance Annexing Certain Territory to the City of Muncie, Indiana, Placing the Same Within Corporate Boundaries Thereof (Annexation Area Number 2: Portions of Heron Point Neighborhood).
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Max Adams, City Attorney 00:14:19.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Brief explanation provided by City Attorney Max Adams noting prior discussions on the annexation.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Adopted by roll call vote (9-0) 00:15:02.
- 00:15:25 **Ordinance 3-25:** An Ordinance to Amend the City of Muncie Comprehensive Zoning Ordinance from the R-4 Residence Zone to the BC Community Business Zone on Premises Located at the Northwest Corner of the Intersection of West Memorial Drive and South Samson Avenue.
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brian Aller, representing the seller and buyer 00:16:06.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion regarding converting a commercial property in a residential zone to allow residential on top and commercial on the bottom.

- **Item-Specific Public Input:** Brian Aller noted the property sits across from a convenience store and the buyer plans a mixed-use conversion [00:16:06](#).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Adopted by roll call vote [00:16:57](#).
- **00:17:20 Ordinance 6-25:** An Ordinance Amending Chapter 77 (Parking Regulations) of the City of Muncie Code of Ordinances regarding Burriss Laboratory School parking.
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Introduced by Council Person Powell, seconded by Councilman Brandon [00:17:36](#).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Brief procedural adoption regarding parking regulations for Burriss Laboratory School.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Adopted by roll call vote [00:18:02](#).
- **00:18:23 Ordinance 7-25:** An Ordinance for Transfer of Appropriations (Police/Fire) seeking to transfer \$526,727.77 from the opioid distribution fund.
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** City administration / Controller's office.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Explanation of transferring funds from the unrestricted opioid settlement fund to support public safety contracts.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Introduced by Voice Vote [00:19:34](#).
- **00:19:41 Ordinance 8-25:** An Ordinance to Amend the City of Muncie Comprehensive Zoning Ordinance from the R-4 Resident Zone to the BV Variety Business Zone on Premises Located at 2810 West Ethel Avenue.
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Michael Foley, representing the petitioner [00:20:23](#).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Petitioner noted the property has been commercial since 1966, received a favorable 9-0 vote at the BC level, and houses nine units. Council members expressed support for correcting the long-standing zoning mismatch.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Michael Foley spoke on behalf of the petitioner [00:20:23](#).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [00:21:42](#).
- **00:21:52 Ordinance 9-25:** An Ordinance to Amend the City of Muncie Comprehensive Zoning Ordinance from the BV Variety Business Zone to the R-3 Residence Zone on Premises Located at 2524 South Madison Avenue (Macedonia Avenue).
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Developer / Petitioner representative.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion regarding a real estate transaction under an FHA loan deadline requiring residential zoning. The property was split from a commercial parcel, completely remodeled as a single-family house, and requires the zoning change to close the loan within two weeks. Note was made of an 8-0 favorable recommendation from the plan commission.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Brief comments from the developer regarding the FHA loan time constraints and the complete residential remodel.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Introduced by Voice Vote [00:25:29](#). Suspension of the rules approved by roll call vote [00:32:21](#). Final adoption passed by roll call vote

00:33:05.

- **00:33:23 Ordinance 10-25:** An Ordinance to Amend the City of Muncie Comprehensive Zoning Ordinance from the R-3 Resident Zone (noted later by counsel as R-4) to the BV Variety Business Zone on Premises Located at the 3700 Block East Centennial Avenue (Lot 2 in Nanny Haven Subdivision).
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Kathy Van Skyock, Ashton Land Surveyor, representing Donna Drake (Drake Properties) 00:34:17; Drew Hall, Attorney 00:38:30.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion regarding a refurbished barn used for secure temporary storage of building materials for home rehabilitation projects. Council members noted property improvements, fence installations, and neighbor accommodations. Received an 8-0 favorable recommendation from the plan commission.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Kathy Van Skyock and Attorney Drew Hall testified regarding the property rehab and storage use 00:34:17, 00:38:30.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Introduced by Voice Vote 00:40:06. Suspension of rules approved by roll call vote 00:40:32. Adopted by roll call vote 00:41:08.
- **00:41:24 Ordinance 11-25:** An Ordinance Fixing the Maximum Salaries of Each and Every Member of the Muncie Police Department for the Year 2025.
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Matt Wagley, Deputy Controller 00:42:08; Chris Degan, Muncie Police Department 00:43:20.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion regarding a 5% salary increase for police officers and command staff, transitioning annual salaries to bi-weekly pay to align with civilian ordinances. Funding is supported by unrestricted opioid settlement funds. A typo in Section 3 regarding the effective date (stating January 5, 2024 instead of January 1, 2025) was identified for amendment.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Audie Barber expressed concerns regarding long-term city spending, potential future LIT tax increases, and the reliance on temporary settlement funds 00:46:14.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Introduced by Voice Vote 00:52:07.
- **00:52:15 Ordinance 12-25:** An Ordinance Fixing the Maximum Salaries of Each and Every Member of the Muncie Fire Department for the Year 2025.
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** City Administration / Controller's Office.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Mirrors the police salary ordinance, providing a 5% salary increase for 2025 corresponding with the newly negotiated union contracts.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:**
 - Audie Barber raised concerns about city debt, tax sustainability, and the status of AFSCME union contracts 00:55:55. (Administration subsequently clarified that AFSCME agreements were being finalized).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Introduced by Voice Vote 01:00:42.
- **01:00:51 Resolution 3-25:** A Resolution of Approval for the 2024 Changes to the Official Zone Maps for the City of Muncie.

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Kylen Swacker, Planning Commission [01:01:38](#).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Incorporation of all six 2024 approved zone changes into official city GIS maps and office records.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Adopted by roll call vote [01:02:20](#).
- **01:02:40 Resolution 4-25:** A Resolution of the Common Council of the City of Muncie Affirming Muncie as an Inclusive Community for All Residents.
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Authored by Council Person Sarah Goan [01:07:54](#).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Council members expressed personal testimonies and strong support for diversity, equity, and inclusion, community infrastructure accessibility, and welcoming all residents.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Charlie Jameson spoke in support of the resolution, emphasizing the importance of welcoming communities, housing, and infrastructure accessibility [01:03:19](#).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Adopted by roll call vote [01:09:33](#).
- **01:09:53 Resolution 5-25:** A Resolution of the Common Council of the City of Muncie to Encourage Relief, Promotion, and/or Communication for Small Businesses in the City of Muncie.
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Julie Snider and Muncie Central High School AP Government students [01:10:30](#).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Students presented a civic engagement project proposing a small business aid package (discount days, parking promotion, tax abatement opportunities) and a collaborative committee comprising local chambers of commerce and small business owners based on a community survey of over 115 responses. Council members praised the students' thorough work and presentation.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Presentation by Muncie Central High School students (including remarks read by Isel Quirk, Aaron Kogasa, Ethan Clinger, Emma Judge, Isaiah Voss, Chad Clark, Hannah, Ian McDaniel, and Jacob Collins) [01:11:21](#).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Adopted by roll call vote [01:20:47](#).
- **01:21:08 Resolution 6-25:** A Resolution of the City of Muncie Transferring Funds Within the City of Muncie Common Council Budget.
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council leadership / City Attorney Gibson.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer of funds within the council budget (from attorney fees to other services and charges) to facilitate the live-streaming of Ethics Commission meetings, with Council Attorney Gibson assisting with costs.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Adopted by roll call vote [01:22:32](#).
- **01:22:54 Resolution 7-25:** A Resolution of the Common Council of the City of Muncie Indiana Approving the Collective Bargaining Agreement with the Greg Winters Memorial Fraternal Order of Police Lodge Number 87.

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brandon Quals, FOP Lodge 87 President [01:23:38](#); Chris Degan, Deputy Chief [01:46:21](#); Sergeant Amy Kessler [01:49:28](#); Brian Ashton, Training Director [01:36](#).
- **Deliberation Summary:** Extensive deliberation regarding police department staffing crises, high call volumes (over 7,000 calls to date in the year), low comparative pay rankings relative to state averages, officer retention, and recruitment challenges. The agreement establishes a 2-year contract (5% increase in year one).
- **Item-Specific Public Input:**
 - Brandon Quals (FOP President) detailed state-wide comparative salary rankings and recruitment difficulties [01:23:38](#).
 - Audie Barber raised ongoing fiscal sustainability and tax concerns [01:41:57](#).
 - Chris Degan, Amy Kessler, and Brian Ashton emphasized the impact of adequate compensation on mental health programs, training standards, and community engagement.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Adopted by roll call vote [02:03:42](#).
- **[01:41:08](#) Resolution 8-25:** A Resolution of the Common Council of the City of Muncie Indiana Approving the Collective Bargaining Agreement with the Muncie Firefighters Local 1348 IAFF AFL-CIO-CLC.
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jason Chapman, Local 1348 President [02:04:51](#).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion regarding the fire department's high per-capita run volume (17,800 calls last year with 122 staff), staffing losses, local physical agility testing innovations to recruit Muncie residents, and comparative regional salaries.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:**
 - Jason Chapman (Union President) presented run-load statistics and salary comparisons [02:04:51](#).
 - Audie Barber questioned city revenue sources and administration funding contributions [02:23:18](#).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Adopted by roll call vote [02:24:03](#).

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **[02:43:34](#) Ralph Privet** (Granville Neighborhood Association): Addressed code enforcement challenges regarding illegal front-yard vehicle parking, storage of boats, and 30-foot industrial subcontractor trailers damaging yards and residential streets. Requested stronger code penalties and landlord accountability.
- **[02:35:48](#) Charlie Jameson:** Discussed broader economic comparisons regarding regional industry growth and tax structures.
- **[02:37:40](#) Audie Barber:** Addressed the council regarding the status of the Muncie Crisis Center, questioning operational hours, Meridian Services' management, and public access.

- [02:40:31](#) **Amber Green** (Communications Director for the City): Provided an administrative update clarifying that the crisis center has been open for over a month and is currently utilizing a slow roll-out model taking clients directly from police calls at Meridian's request.
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:** Administrative updates provided regarding the phased opening of the crisis center and upcoming collaborative informational meetings.
 - **Adjournment:** Meeting adjourned following a motion and unanimous vote [02:42:17](#).
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